

Day 92 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in History & National Movement (7): Somnath Temple's 1,000-Year Amrut Mahotsav

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Somnath Amrut Mahotsav (2026), marking 1,000 years since the temple's first recorded invasion, and the historical figures behind its modern reconstruction.

Q: What milestone did the 'Somnath Amrut Mahotsav' (2026) commemorate?

A: 1,000 years since the Somnath Temple's first invasion, by Mahmud of Ghazni in 1026 CE.

Q: What is Somnath Temple's religious significance?

A: It is considered the FIRST among the 12 Jyotirlingas of Lord Shiva.

Q: Name some historical figures/invasions associated with Somnath Temple's repeated destruction and reconstruction.

A: Invasions: 1026 CE (Mahmud of Ghazni), 1311, 1326, 1395, 1451 CE, and a destruction order by Aurangzeb in the 17th century.
Reconstruction figures: King Kumarapala, Ahilyabai Holkar, and (in modern India) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.

Q: When was the temple reconsecrated in independent India, and by whom?

A: 1951, by Dr. Rajendra Prasad, India's first President — Somnath was the very first temple reconstructed in free India.

Q: What commemorative coin was released in 2026 to mark this 1,000-year milestone, and what are its specifications?

A: A ₹75 commemorative coin (gazette notification dated 8 May 2026) — composition: pure silver (99.9%), weight 40 grams, diameter 44 mm, with 200 serrations along the edge. Released by PM Narendra Modi at Veraval, Gujarat, along with a commemorative postal stamp.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Somnath Amrut Mahotsav (2026) marked 1,000 years since the temple's first invasion by:

A. Muhammad bin Qasim

B. Mahmud of Ghazni ✓

C. Muhammad of Ghor

D. Timur

Explanation: Mahmud of Ghazni (1026 CE). [medium, web-research]

2. Somnath Temple is considered which Jyotirlinga among the 12 Jyotirlingas of Lord Shiva?

A. The first ✓

B. The fifth

C. The seventh

D. The twelfth

Explanation: The first. [medium, web-research]

3. Somnath Temple was reconsecrated in independent India in 1951 by:

A. Jawaharlal Nehru

B. Dr. Rajendra Prasad ✓

C. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

D. C. Rajagopalachari

Explanation: Dr. Rajendra Prasad, India's first President. [medium, web-research]

4. Which freedom-movement leader played a key role in Somnath Temple's modern reconstruction effort?

A. Subhas Chandra Bose

B. Bal Gangadhar Tilak

C. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel ✓

D. Lala Lajpat Rai

Explanation: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel. [medium, web-research]

5. The ₹75 commemorative coin marking Somnath's 1,000-year milestone (gazette notification 8 May 2026) is made of:

A. Pure gold (99.9%)

B. Pure silver (99.9%) ✓

C. Bronze

D. Copper-nickel alloy

Explanation: Pure silver (99.9%), 40 grams, 44mm diameter. [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Puzzles

READING MATERIAL

Puzzles is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. The genre overlaps with Logical Reasoning, so this topic focuses on archetypes NOT already covered there: comparison chains, age puzzles, family-relation puzzles, and linear seating arrangements — all extremely common TNPSC puzzle shapes.

Q: Method — comparison chain (not all four compared directly, must chain through clues): D is taller than C but not as tall as B. C is taller than A. Who is the tallest?

A: Chain it: $B > D > C > A$. So B is the tallest. The key technique: write each clue as an inequality, then merge them into one ordered chain rather than trying to compare all pairs mentally.

Q: Method — classic age puzzle: A father is 4 times as old as his son. In 20 years, he will be twice as old as his son. Find their current ages.

A: Let son's current age = x , father = $4x$. In 20 years: father = $4x+20$, son = $x+20$. Condition: $4x+20 = 2(x+20) \rightarrow 4x+20 = 2x+40 \rightarrow 2x=20 \rightarrow x=10$. Son is 10, father is 40.

Q: Method — family-relation puzzle: Pointing to a photograph, a man says, 'She is the daughter of my mother's only son.' How is the woman in the photo related to the man?

A: His daughter. 'My mother's only son' = the man himself (since he's referring to his own mother, and he's an only son). So 'her father' = the man, making the woman his daughter.

Q: Method — linear seating arrangement: Five friends P, Q, R, S, T sit in a row. Q is immediately to the right of P. R is at one end. S is between Q and T. T is not adjacent to P. Find the order.

A: Work from the most fixed clue first: R is at an end — try R at the left end. P-Q must be adjacent with Q right of P, and S is between Q and T, with T not adjacent to P. Testing R,P,Q,S,T: P-Q adjacent ✓, S between Q&T ✓, T not adjacent to P (T is at position 5, P at position 2, not adjacent) ✓, R at an end ✓. Order: R, P, Q, S, T.

Q: Method — distribution/sharing puzzle: A sum of money is divided among A, B, and C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets thrice as much as C. If C gets ₹600, find the total sum.

A: $C=600$. $B=3 \times 600=1800$. $A=2 \times 1800=3600$. Total = $3600+1800+600 = 6000$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. P is shorter than Q but taller than R. Q is shorter than S. Who is the tallest?

- A. P
- B. Q
- C. R
- D. S ✓**

Explanation: Chain: $S > Q > P > R$. S is tallest. [medium, authored]

2. A mother is 3 times as old as her daughter. In 15 years, she will be twice as old as her daughter. Find the daughter's current age.

- A. 10
- B. 12
- C. 15 ✓**
- D. 18

Explanation: Daughter= x , mother= $3x$. $3x+15=2(x+15) \rightarrow 3x+15=2x+30 \rightarrow x=15$. [medium, authored]

3. Pointing to a man, a woman says, 'He is the son of my father's only daughter.' If the woman has no siblings, how is the man related to her?

- A. Her son ✓**
- B. Her brother
- C. Her nephew
- D. Her father

Explanation: 'My father's only daughter' = the woman herself (she has no siblings). So the man is her son. [medium, authored]

4. ₹7,000 is divided among A, B, C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets twice as much as C. Find C's share.

- A. ₹1,000 ✓**
- B. ₹1,200

C. ₹1,500

D. ₹2,000

Explanation: Let $C=x$, $B=2x$, $A=4x$. $\text{Total}=7x=7000 \rightarrow x=1,000$. [medium, authored]

5. Four friends sit in a row. B is immediately right of A. C is at the left end. D is not adjacent to A. Find the correct order.

A. C, A, B, D ✓

B. A, B, C, D

C. C, D, A, B

D. D, A, B, C

Explanation: C at left end; A-B adjacent with B right of A; D not adjacent to A. Order C,A,B,D satisfies all three conditions. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Your Space" — David Bates

READING MATERIAL

A didactic poem urging gentle, kind speech toward everyone — especially children, the elderly, and the poor. Real coaching-site evidence tests theme, in-context word meaning, and figure-of-speech together, similar to the other Guest/Van-Dyke-style moral poems already covered.

Q: What is the central theme/message of "Your Space"?

A: Speak gently and kindly — to everyone, but especially to children, the elderly, and the poor. Harsh words can ruin the good we might otherwise do; kindness builds trust and love far better than fear or force does.

Q: Why does the poet say we should speak gently to children specifically?

A: To earn their trust and love — childhood is brief, and gentle, caring words said to children in that short period are the ones they'll remember always.

Q: Why does the poet urge gentle speech toward the elderly?

A: Because in their last years, all they need is affection and love — the poet says to speak to them as tenderly as to a child, so they may depart in peace.

Q: Why does the poet urge gentle speech toward the poor?

A: The poor are already suffering in an unkind world — there's no need to add to that suffering with harsh tones or unkind words.

Q: What does "Sands of life are nearly run" refer to?

A: Time running out for the aged — an image of an hourglass nearly empty, used to describe someone near the end of their life.

Q: What does "mar" mean in "let not harsh words mar the good we might do here"?

A: Ruin/spoil — harsh words can ruin good deeds, even when the deeds themselves were well-intentioned.

Q: Identify the figure of speech in "Speak gently! — 'tis a little thing / Dropped in the heart's deep well."

A: Metaphor — a spoken word is described AS something physically 'dropped' into the heart, pictured as a 'deep well', without using 'like/as'.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Your Space" was written by:

- A. Rudyard Kipling
- B. David Bates ✓**
- C. Sarojini Naidu
- D. Robert Frost

Explanation: David Bates. [easy, web-research]

2. The main theme of the poem is:

- A. Anger and revenge
- B. Speaking powerfully
- C. Speaking gently and kindly ✓**
- D. Arguing with boldness

Explanation: Speaking gently and kindly to everyone. [easy, web-research]

3. In the poem, why should we speak gently to a child?

- A. To avoid punishment
- B. To earn their trust and love ✓**
- C. To teach discipline
- D. To save time

Explanation: To earn their trust and love. [medium, web-research]

4. "Sands of life are nearly run" refers to:

- A. A desert trip
- B. Time running out for the aged ✓**
- C. A sand-clock game

D. A beach adventure

Explanation: Time running out for the aged. [medium, web-research]

5. In "let not harsh words mar the good we might do here," the word "mar" means:

A. Help

B. Fix

C. Ruin ✓

D. Repair

Explanation: Ruin/spoil. [medium, web-research]

6. "Speak gently! – 'tis a little thing / Dropped in the heart's deep well" uses which figure of speech?

A. Simile

B. Personification

C. Metaphor ✓

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Metaphor — a spoken word equated with something dropped into a 'deep well'. [medium, web-research]